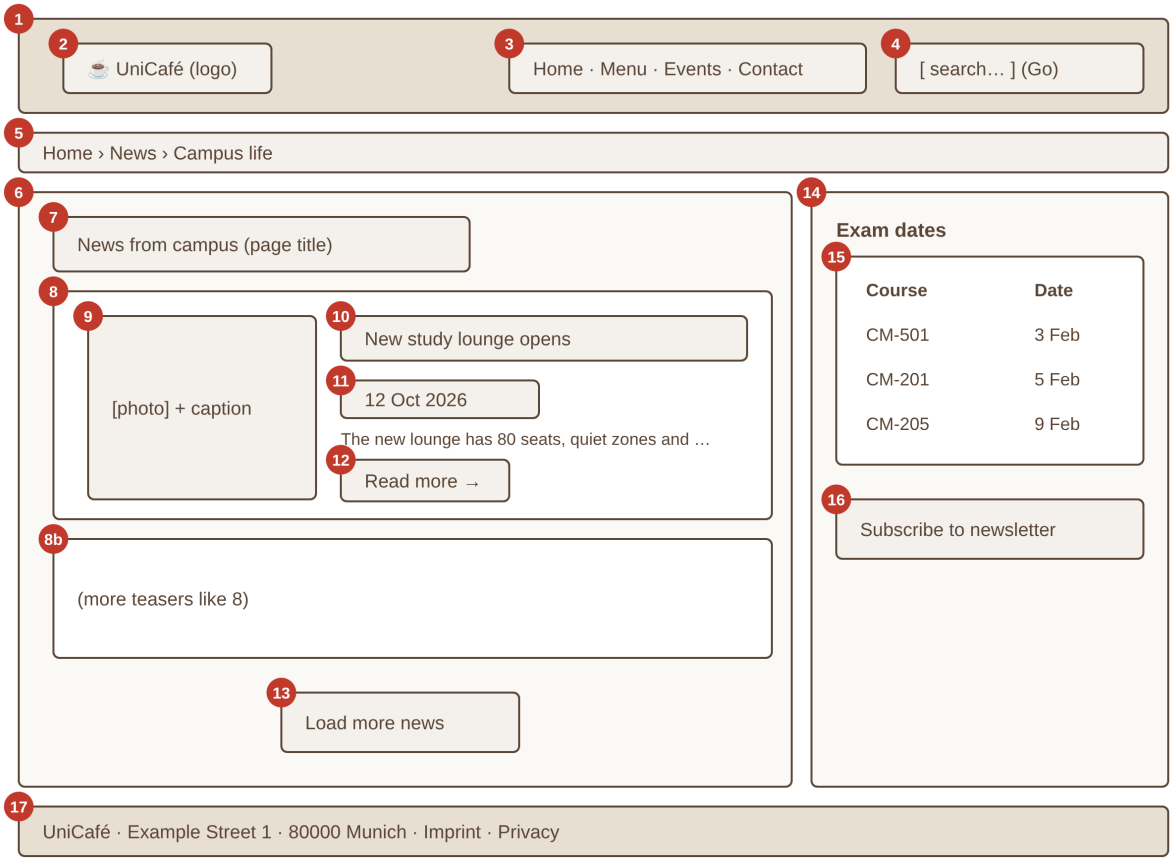
Session 3 Labs: Semantic HTML

CM-501 Frontend Web Development · EPA 2

Names: Edgars Zeltmanis

Activity · Tag that box (teams, 10 min)

Write the HTML element(s) you would use for every number. More than one element per box is allowed (e.g. `nav` + `ul`).



#	Element(s)	#	Element(s)	#	Element(s)
1	header	7	h1	13	button (loads more on same page, no navigation)
2	a href="/" + img alt="UniCafe - home"	8	article (one per teaser; 8b too)	14	aside + h2 "Exam dates"
3	nav aria-label="Main" + ul > li > a	9	figure + img alt + figcaption	15	table + caption, thead/tbody, th scope="col"
4	search + form: label, input type=search, button	10	h2 (+ a href to the article)	16	a href to sign-up page (or form + label + input type=email + button)
5	nav aria-label="Breadcrumb" + ol > li > a	11	time datetime="2026-10-12"	17	footer + address + a href (Imprint, Privacy)
6	main	12	a href (navigates to article)		

Lab D · Div-soup surgery (pairs, 20 min)

File: `lab-files/events-divsoup.html` (course page). One laptop per pair; switch the driver after 10 minutes.

Your job: make the page semantic. It should look almost the same afterwards. You may change the selectors in the `<style>` block when you change elements (e.g. `.header` → `header`).

Checklist

- ☑ `<html lang="en">`, a meaningful `<title>` (page · site), viewport meta tag
- ☑ landmarks: `header`, `nav` (with `aria-label`), `main` (exactly one), `aside`, `footer`
- ☑ **one** `h1`, then `h2` (no skipped levels)
- ☑ navigation = list of **real links** (`<a href>`), no `onclick`
- ☑ every event is an `<article>` with a heading
- ☑ dates in `<time datetime="…">`
- ☑ "Reserve a seat": **link or button?** Decide and justify: Link - it goes to another page (contact); a button would do something on this page
- ☑ opening hours: which element fits name–value pairs? dl (dt + dd)
- ☑ address in `<address>`, phone number as a `tel:` link
- ☑ bonus: a **skip link** to `main`

Check your result

1. **validator.w3.org/nu** → "Check by file upload": number of errors: 0 warnings: 0 (via validator.nu)
2. DevTools → Elements → **Accessibility** pane (Chrome: enable *full-page accessibility tree*). Sketch the top level of the tree:

   RootWebArea "Events · Campus Café"
   - link "Skip to content"
   - banner > link "Campus Café", navigation "Main" > list > 4 x listitem > link
   - main
     - heading "Events" (level 1), paragraph
     - 3 x article > heading (level 2), time, link "Reserve a seat for ..."
   - complementary "Opening hours and address"
     - heading (2), description list, heading (2), group (address) > link (tel)
   - contentinfo > links "Imprint", "Privacy"

3. Disable CSS (`for (const s of document.styleSheets) s.disabled = true;`). Does the page still make sense? Yes

   Without CSS it reads top-down in a sensible order: skip link, site name, nav list, h1, the three events, opening hours + address, footer.

Lab E · Before vs after, without looking (pairs, 25 min)

Tester: uses a **screen reader** (or **keyboard only**, if no screen reader works). Eyes closed or screen covered. **Observer:** reads the task aloud, measures the time, writes down what happened. **Swap roles after task 2.**

Pages: `https://rathmayers.github.io/campus-cafe-demo/before/` and `…/after/`

	macOS VoiceOver	Windows NVDA	Keyboard only
on / off	`Cmd + F5`	`Ctrl + Alt + N` / `Insert + Q`	–
next heading	rotor `VO + U`, choose Headings	`H`	–
next landmark	rotor → Landmarks	`D`	–
list of links	rotor → Links	`Insert + F7`	–
next element / activate	`VO + →` / `VO + Space`	↓ / `Enter`	`Tab` / `Enter`, `Space`

VO = `Ctrl + Option`. Stop the task after 3 minutes and write "not done".

Task	Version	Done?	Time	What got in the way?
1. What is **today's special** and what does it cost? (start: home page)	before	no		Special is only an image (special.png) with no alt; "Today" is a styled div, not a heading, so the headings list is empty; marquee + cookie banner get read first.
	after	yes		h2 "Today's special" found via headings: Pumpkin Spice Latte, 3,90 EUR.
2. Go to the **menu**. How much is a **flat white**?	before	slow		Nav items are divs with onclick: not in links list, not focusable. Only way in: "click here" link in body text. Menu is a layout table, h4 only, prices in <font>.
	after	yes		Nav link "Menu" > h2 Coffee > h3 Flat White, 3,60 EUR.
3. Find the café's **phone number**.	before	no		Phone number only inside contact.png (no alt); footer icon links have href="#" and no name.
	after	yes		address with tel: link in footer and on the contact page.
4. **Keyboard only:** from the home page, reach the contact form and put the focus in the first field. Can you **see** where the focus is?	before	no		Nav divs can't be reached with Tab, so the contact page can't be opened. On the contact page: fields have only placeholders (no labels), "Send" is a div, and * { outline: none !important } hides the focus.
	after	yes		Skip link, Tab to "Contact", Enter, Tab to "Name *" (label). 3px focus outline visible.

Our three biggest barriers on "before" and the WCAG principle (Perceivable, Operable, Understandable, Robust):

1. Key info only in images without alt text (today's special, phone number) — (P) / O / U / R)
2. Nav, "Send", "Accept all" are clickable divs: no keyboard access, focus outline removed — (P / (O) / U / R)
3. Form fields have only placeholders, no labels; every page is titled "Home" — (P / O / (U) / R)

Activity · Alt text or not? (teams, 10 min)

For each image: write the `alt` text, or `alt=""` if it is decorative, and say why in one sentence.

	Image and context	`alt="…"`	Why?
A	“Today’s special” image with text, on the menu page	alt="Today's special: Pumpkin Spice Latte, 3,90 EUR, only until 4 pm"	Image of text: the alt must say exactly what the text in the image says.
B	image with phone number and e-mail, on the contact page	alt="Phone +49 89 000 000 00, e-mail hello@campus-cafe.example"	The contact data exists only in the image, so the alt has to carry all of it.
C	croissant photo next to the heading “Fresh every morning”	alt=""	Decorative: the heading already says it; describing a croissant adds nothing.
D	microphone on a stage, in the teaser “Open Mic Night”	alt=""	Mood picture; the teaser heading and text carry the information.
E	big hero image behind the text “Good coffee for long study days”	alt="" (better: CSS background-image)	Decorative backdrop behind text that is already real text.
F	Instagram icon, the only content of a link	alt="Instagram"	Only content of the link, so the alt is the link's name: say where it goes, not "icon".

Which two of these images should not be images at all? Why? _____

A and B. They are images of text: a screen reader, zoom, copy/paste, search and translation can't use them, and the phone number can't be tapped. Write them as real HTML text instead (B with tel: and mailto: links). WCAG 1.4.5 Images of Text.